

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Vincent Van Faux

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Vincent Van Faux

Celebrated Contemporary Painter

Vincent believes even his shopping lists belong in a documentary. He is truly a genius of the visual arts. Vincent became famous young and has been trying ever since to convince people that this is not the same thing as becoming famous accidentally.

- Went to art school with **Dada DiCapo**. **Dada** enjoys reminding Vincent of this in front of collectors.
- **Hugh Bidder** wants to represent Vincent. Vincent has yet to approve **Hugh**'s percentage.
- **Penny Pincher** keeps showing Vincent photos of paintings and asking what they are worth. He's not interested.
- **Al Baster** compares their commissions by weight. Vincent would prefer to discuss the price.

ACTING TIPS

Warm, competitive, mercurial, self-aware enough to joke about his ego but not enough to lose it.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Vincent Van Faux. My new work is here tonight. My early work is also here, despite several very expensive objections.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant owned an embarrassing student painting you have spent years trying to buy back. He planned to display it tonight beside your celebrated recent work as a joke about 'humble beginnings.'

Your other secret

You have secretly used buyers to acquire several of your own early paintings so you could remove them from circulation. The art world would find that both vain and market-manipulative.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Ella Gance knows you were behind the anonymous buybacks.
- Persuade Claire O'Scuro that the student painting should not be displayed.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Find the biography of the man who chose conscience over obedience. Its pages have company.*
- 2 *Look inside the vessel that usually gives cut flowers a place to stand.*
- 3 *Find the green light, then examine the space nearby.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

ACT I: MOTIVE



Vincent Van Faux

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The anonymous buybacks were mine. I paid to remove my student paintings from circulation. Grant owned the worst one and wanted it beside my recent work as a joke. A patron buying art is charming. A patron buying the right to humiliate its painter is a different transaction.

IF MURDERER

I arranged the buybacks because early work should sometimes remain early work. Grant refused to sell his student painting back. He wanted the gala to laugh at it. He had never painted anything, yet tonight he intended to become the author of my reputation.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Vincent Van Faux

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Vincent Van Faux

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I turned my student painting toward the wall and removed its sale notice. Grant had positioned it beside the new work without asking me. I had brought cash to buy it back; he would not name a price. The registrar told me to restore the display. I restored the painting and kept the notice. There was a blank space where I had painted over my own signature years ago. I did not need that pointed out to the room.

IF MURDERER

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Vincent Van Faux

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Vincent Van Faux

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The replacement sketch is on the back of the student picture's sale notice. The painted-out signature is mine. I prepared the cash before the gala and took it home again when Grant refused. The notice and withdrawal receipt corroborate the buyback I tried to conceal. A very expensive lesson in being ashamed of one's own work.

IF MURDERER

Grant rejected my replacement sketch. The signature I painted over was mine; I wanted the student work taken out of the exhibition. I had prepared cash for the purchase and did not want its owner to know what I would pay. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my sketch wallet. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass before spreading out the replacement sketch.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I bought my own early paintings back and tried to buy this one too. I was ashamed of it. The sale notice and cash withdrawal survive; I can stop pretending those purchases were anonymous collectors. I did not murder Grant. The registrar can hang the student picture beside the new one. I will have to survive the comparison.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my sketch wallet when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He planned to use my old painting to humiliate me. I murdered my patron rather than endure his unveiling.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.